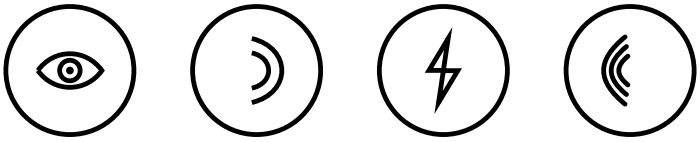
ANIMAL SUPER SENSES

A science guessing game

12 clue cards · Answers on a separate page · A4, black only



See Hear Electric Far sounds

How to play

1. Cut out the 12 clue cards along the dashed lines. Keep this front page and the answer page for the reader. Do not cut up the answer page.
2. Shuffle the cards. One person is the reader. Everyone else guesses.
3. The reader picks a card and reads Clue 1 aloud. Anyone may guess. If nobody is right, read Clue 2, then Clue 3.
4. Scoring (optional): a correct guess after Clue 1 is worth 3 points, after Clue 2 is worth 2 points, and after Clue 3 is worth 1 point. Then move to the next card.
5. Wrong guesses are fine. Just keep going, or agree that a wrong guess means you wait until the next clue.
6. After all 12 cards, the highest score wins. Or skip the points and play just for fun.
7. Talk about the sense: how is it like a human sense? How is it different? The answer page has a short, checked fact for each card.
8. Solo play: read the clues, write your guess, then check the answer page.

Who is it for?
About ages 8 and up. Younger players can join if someone reads the clues aloud.

Printing tip
Print at actual size (100%) on A4, black only. Strong black lines, no grey. Best on a Phomemo or Itari M08F thermal printer, or any mono laser / inkjet. Leave the margins as they are.

A note on the science
Clues use well-established findings from museums, wildlife services, and universities. A few popular “super sense” claims are left out when the evidence is still unsettled. Sources are listed in the README.

1 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I fly at night. People sometimes say I cannot see, but that is not true.

Clue 2
I make clicks too high for human ears. The echoes bounce back and build a sound-map of the dark.

Clue 3
I can snag a tiny insect in mid-air this way.

What animal am I?

2 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I hunt in the ocean. I have no outer ears, but a hidden line along my sides feels movement in the water.

Clue 2
When I get very close, tiny jelly-filled pores on my snout pick up weak electric signals.

Clue 3
Even the heartbeat or muscle twitch of hidden prey can give it away.

What animal am I?

3 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I slither, and I can hunt when it is completely dark.

Clue 2
Between my nostrils and my eyes I have special pits that sense heat, not ordinary light.

Clue 3
A warm animal up to about a metre (about three feet) away can stand out to me, even if it is hiding.

What animal am I?

4 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I hunt at night and fly on very quiet wings.

Clue 2
My ears are hidden under feathers. In many of my kind, one ear sits higher than the other.

Clue 3
That difference helps me pinpoint a mouse by a faint rustle in leaves or snow, even in the dark.

What animal am I?

5 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I live in the sea, but I am a mammal that breathes air, not a fish.

Clue 2
I make rapid clicks and listen for the echoes, so I can “see” with sound underwater.

Clue 3
This helps me find fish even when the water is murky.

What animal am I?

6 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I visit flowers to collect nectar and pollen.

Clue 2
I can see ultraviolet light, a kind of light that people cannot see.

Clue 3
Many flowers have hidden ultraviolet patterns that point me toward the nectar in the centre.

What animal am I?

7 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I live in wet soil near streams and ponds, and I do not rely much on eyesight.

Clue 2
Around my nose are 22 short, fleshy rays that I tap on the ground many times a second.

Clue 3
Those rays hold tens of thousands of tiny touch organs, so I can identify a small meal in a fraction of a second.

What animal am I?

8 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
Each year I may travel a very long way, sometimes thousands of kilometres.

Clue 2
Besides the Sun, the stars, and landmarks, I can detect Earth’s magnetic field and use it like a compass.

Clue 3
In famous tests, European robins in cages hopped in a new direction when the magnetic field around them was turned.

What animal am I?

9 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I am a common family animal, and I am famous for my nose.

Clue 2
I have far more scent receptors than a person. A figure often given is about 300 million, compared with about 6 million in humans. The exact number varies by breed.

Clue 3
I can sample smells separately with each nostril, which helps me follow a scent trail.

What animal am I?

10 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I am the largest animal that lives on land.

Clue 2
I make deep rumbles. Many of these sounds are so low that people cannot hear them well. This is called infrasound.

Clue 3
These calls can travel several kilometres and help my family stay in touch.

What animal am I?

11 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I am a large bird of prey. I soar high and hunt in the daytime.

Clue 2
My eyes are packed with light-detecting cells, which gives me very sharp vision.

Clue 3
I can spot a moving rabbit from about a mile (about 1.6 kilometres) away.

What animal am I?

12 **CLUE CARD**
Read one clue at a time.

Clue 1
I am a mammal that lays eggs, and I live in rivers in Australia.

Clue 2
When I dive, I close my eyes, ears, and nostrils.

Clue 3
My soft bill is packed with sensors that pick up tiny electric signals from the muscles of shrimp and other prey in the mud.

What animal am I?

ANSWER PAGE

Keep this page uncut · For the reader or teacher

1 Bat — Echolocation

Finding the way with sound echoes

Many bats send out ultrasound and listen to the returning echoes. This is called echolocation. Bats are not blind; many see well in dim light.

2 Shark — Electroreception

Sensing weak electricity in water

Sharks (and rays) have jelly-filled pores called the ampullae of Lorenzini. These detect weak electric fields made by living animals. Sharks also feel water movement with a lateral line.

3 Pit viper — Heat sensing

Finding warm prey with heat pits

Pit vipers have heat-sensitive pits between the eyes and nostrils. The pits can detect a warm animal up to about a metre (about three feet) away. Some pythons and boas have heat sensors too.

4 Owl — Directional hearing

Pinpointing prey by sound

In many owl species, one ear sits higher than the other. A sound then reaches each ear at a slightly different time and loudness, which helps the owl locate prey in darkness.

5 Dolphin — Echolocation

Seeing with sound underwater

Dolphins and other toothed whales use echolocation: they make clicks and listen for echoes to find prey and to navigate, including in murky water.

6 Honey bee — Ultraviolet vision

Seeing flower patterns we cannot see

Bees can detect ultraviolet light. Many flowers have ultraviolet “nectar guides” — patterns we cannot see — that help a bee find the centre of the flower quickly.

7 Star-nosed mole — Touch

Feeling the world with a star-shaped nose

The star-nosed mole has 22 fleshy rays around its nostrils, covered with about 25,000 touch organs called Eimer’s organs. It can identify small prey in a fraction of a second.

8 Migratory bird — Magnetoreception

Using Earth’s magnetic field as a compass

Many migratory birds can detect Earth’s magnetic field and use it like a compass. In classic tests, European robins changed direction when the field around them was rotated. How the sense works is still being studied.

9 Dog — Smell

Tracking the world with a powerful nose

Dogs have far more scent receptors than people. A figure often given is about 300 million, versus about 6 million in humans; the number varies by breed. Dogs can also sample air separately with each nostril.

10 Elephant — Infrasound

Calling with very low sounds that travel far

Elephants make deep rumbles, including sounds too low for people to hear well. These calls can travel several kilometres and help family groups stay in touch. Range depends on the habitat and the weather.

11 Bald eagle — Sharp vision

Spotting prey from high in the air

Bald eagles have very sharp daytime vision. A U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service fact sheet says a bald eagle can spot a moving rabbit almost a mile (about 1.6 kilometres) away.

12 Platypus — Electroreception

Finding prey with an electric-sensing bill

When a platypus dives, it closes its eyes, ears, and nostrils. Its bill holds tens of thousands of electroreceptors, plus touch sensors, that pick up tiny electric signals from prey in the water.